

MetLife's BIG MATCH

A StorySprout Press Book



MetLife's **BIG MATCH**





The sun hadn't even finished waking up, but Alex was already wide awake! Today wasn't just any Saturday. Today was the day of the World Cup Match!

"Alex, are you ready?" Dad called from the hallway.

"I've been ready since last year, Dad!" Alex shouted back, pulling on his lucky jersey.



As they drove down the long highway, Alex pressed his face against the window. There it was! MetLife Stadium.

It looked like a giant silver palace. Did you know MetLife has over 82,000 seats? Alex wondered if he could count them all.



As Alex stepped out of the car, he heard a deep, rumbling hum. It wasn't the wind — it was the stadium itself!

MetLife was a friendly giant. He had big lights for eyes that glowed a warm yellow, and his skin was made of shimmering glass and metal.



The giant stadium stretched out his goalpost arms to welcome everyone. Alex felt like he was walking into the heart of a friendly giant.

"Welcome to the Meadowlands!" the giant seemed to whisper. Alex high-fived a silver panel. It felt cool and strong.



Inside, the stadium was buzzing like a beehive!
Fans from Argentina wore blue and white stripes,
while fans from the USA wore red, white, and blue.
The air smelled like popcorn and excitement. Alex
could hear music playing and people singing songs
in different languages.



Then, they walked through the tunnel. *WHOOSH!*

The stadium opened up! The bright green grass looked like a velvet carpet. The sky was a brilliant blue, and the silver walls reached up toward the clouds.



MetLife

Suddenly, the music got louder. *BOOM!* Fireworks exploded over the silver rim of the stadium, painting the sky with sparkles.

The pre-game show had begun! Dancers moved across the grass, and giant flags fluttered in the breeze.



"There they are!" Dad shouted. The players walked out, looking like heroes in a storybook. Team USA looked strong, and Team Argentina looked fast. Alex cheered as loud as he could.

METLIFE STADIUM



TWEET! The whistle blew, and the match began!
The ball zipped across the green grass like a shooting star. Argentina's star player was as fast as a rabbit! But the USA defenders were as strong as lions.



Back and forth they went! Alex watched every move.
"Pass it! Pass it!" Alex yelled. The USA player
kicked the ball to his teammate. They were moving
closer to the goal!



The ball flew high into the air. A USA player jumped up and — *BONK!* — he hit the ball with his head! The goalkeeper dived to the left. The ball spun to the right. Everyone held their breath.



GOALLLLLLLLL! The stadium erupted! The roar was so loud that Alex felt it in his toes. Alex and Dad hugged, jumping up and down. Even the MetLife giant shivered with joy!



Between periods, Alex enjoyed a delicious stadium hot dog. Suddenly, he looked up at the giant video board. "Dad, look! It's us!" Alex and Dad were on the big screen!



The next period began, and Argentina was determined. "They're very good," Alex said. "They are," Dad agreed. "That's why the World Cup is so special — the best teams in the world play here."



Argentina kicked a powerful shot. *SWISH!* It went right into the corner of the net. Now the score was tied! Alex felt a little sad, but then he saw the players high-five each other.



"That was a great goal," Dad said. "In soccer, we cheer for our team, but we also respect the other team. That's called sportsmanship." Alex began to clap for the great play too.



The clock was ticking down. Only a few minutes left! The sun began to set, and the MetLife giant's silver skin turned orange and gold. He turned on his light-bulb eyes to help everyone see.



USA took one last shot. *CLANG!* It hit the post and bounced away. The stadium giant felt the vibration. Everyone groaned, then laughed. It was so close!

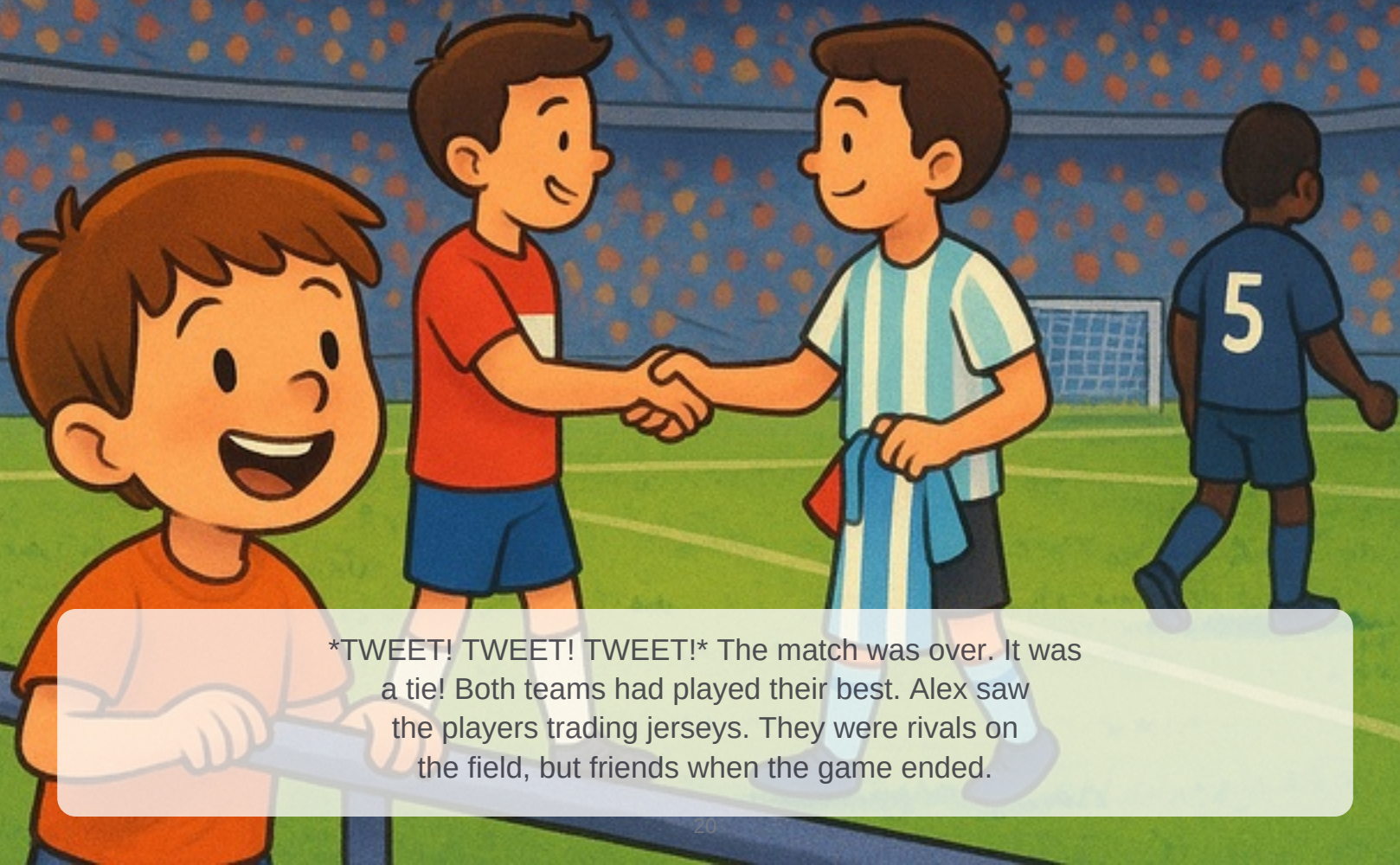
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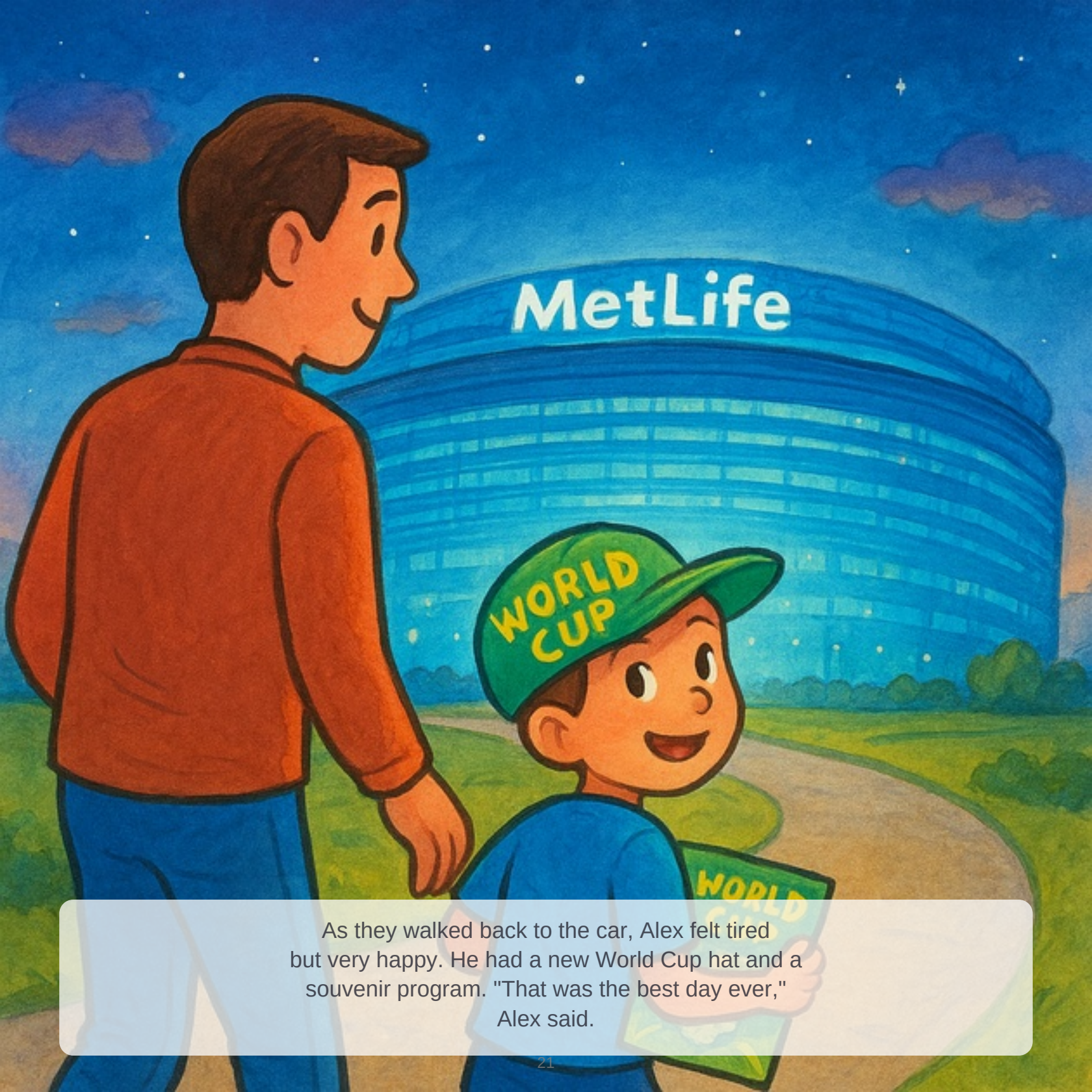
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TWEET! TWEET! TWEET! The match was over. It was a tie! Both teams had played their best. Alex saw the players trading jerseys. They were rivals on the field, but friends when the game ended.



As they walked back to the car, Alex felt tired but very happy. He had a new World Cup hat and a souvenir program. "That was the best day ever," Alex said.



In the car, Alex's eyes grew heavy. He dreamed of dribbling the ball through the Meadowlands, scoring the winning goal in the World Cup Final. Dad smiled and turned the radio down low.



The fans went home, and the stadium grew quiet.
The MetLife giant settled back into the grass. He
had a big job coming up in 2026 — hosting the
World Cup Final!

DID YOU KNOW?

MetLife Stadium is made of enough steel to build 25 Eiffel Towers!

MetLife



MetLife Stadium is ready for the world! Will you be there to cheer?

****Fun Fact:**** MetLife Stadium will host the 2026 World Cup Final! It's made of 40,000 tons of steel — that's a lot of metal for one friendly giant!

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